Abdullah Al Zahid

Toronto, ON | (780) 982-3680 | azahid1@ualberta.ca | linkedin.com/in/abdullah-al-zahid

October 23, 2026

Hiring Manager
Transportation Planning Section, Planning and Economic Development
City of Hamilton

Re: Job ID #32289, Senior Project Manager, Mobility Planning

Dear Hiring Manager,

I would like to apply for the Senior Project Manager, Mobility Planning position. I am an Assistant Planner in Transportation Planning at the City of Toronto, with a master's degree in transportation engineering from the University of Alberta, and the work in this posting is close to what I do now.

At the City I review development applications and the transportation studies filed with them, analyze Transportation Tomorrow Survey data, and write the briefing notes that carry issues and options to senior staff. I run assigned projects from scoping through to recommendations, coordinating divisions, consultants and outside agencies whose priorities do not always line up. I also built the Transportation Data Dashboard, which brought several survey years into one validated source. Earlier, at Metrolinx, I simulated GO rail operations in OpenTrack, and at Mott MacDonald I worked on Ontario Line construction staging, so I have seen regional transit planning from the provincial side.

At Metrolinx I set up a command line workflow that pre-simulated slow orders in batches, cutting turnaround on scenario requests from days to hours, and built the Crew Variance Tool, a Python application that read large JSON operations files and summarised speed profiles and run-time variance across subdivisions.

I should be straightforward about the gaps. I have not supervised or directed a team of project managers, and I have not managed a section budget, written RFPs or administered consultant contracts. I have not run public engagement to IAP2 standards, and my work on Environmental Assessments and Complete Streets guidelines has been limited. I do not hold an MCIP, RPP, C.E.T. or P.Eng. designation, and I do not have a Class G licence. I am applying because the transportation planning, development review and data work is where my experience sits.

Thank you for considering my application.

Sincerely,

Abdullah Al Zahid

Abdullah Al Zahid